

geologist and father of two young children in Houston who writes the blog *Slowly Sipping Coffee*, explained that his blog's name came from a light bulb moment that he and his wife had on a Friday off work. They realized how much they enjoyed simply having the freedom to sit down together, sip their coffee, and talk. They compared this to typical weekdays, which were characterized by running around, getting themselves and their kids ready, then grabbing the coffee while running out the door to drink alone while driving to work.

FI is not about running away from the things you hate in life. It's about running toward something. It's being intentional about life and not just grazing through it. Once you start living intentionally, earning, spending, and investing decisions become much easier. Decisions that previously seemed hard and felt like sacrifices become automatic as they drive you toward your desired outcome.

Having an Awakening

A common theme among those who have achieved or are along the path to FI is knowing they wanted something different from a conventional lifestyle. But before getting on the path to FI, they didn't truly believe that it was actually possible to achieve this vastly